

Resource-Based View (VRIN)

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DEFINITION

Sustained advantage comes from resources that are Valuable, Rare, Inimitable and Non-substitutable.

KEY POINTS

- Advantage lives inside the firm, not only in industry position
- A resource must clear all four VRIN tests to sustain advantage
- Complements Porter's outside-in view with an inside-out one
- Use when the answer lies in the firm's assets or capabilities

REFERENCE

Barney, J. (1991) 'Firm resources and sustained competitive advantage', *Journal of Management*, 17(1), pp. 99-120.